Jesuwui La: Hymns in Tangkhul Naga

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Preface & Archival Information

Jesuwui La: Hymns in Tangkhul Naga, compiled and translated by Rev. William Pettigrew (American Baptist Mission House, Ukhrul, Manipur, Assam, 1907, 2nd Edition; printed at Baptist Mission Press, Calcutta). Preserves the earliest published Christian hymnal and devotional poetry in the Ukhrul dialect of Tangkhul Naga.

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Chapter 1: Early Devotional Hymns

CHAPTER 1: EARLY DEVOTIONAL HYMNS

Summary: Classic devotional hymns including 'Jesus Loves Me' (Hi Jesuna Laishi).

TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

1. Hi Jesuna laishi, khikala jila, in a Vare chiwui lairikli, palaga I shitsanga. Ma, ili laishi! Ma, ili laishi! Ma, ili laishi! Lairikli iya.
2. Hi Jesuna laishi, A mangla chihomihai; Varina kaching khamaug shomida changmilakra. 3. Ili Jesuna laishi, noshino awui nona; athum masathukmana, Ana kamakangvana. 4. Hi Jesuna laishi, iwui moral pheomira; khikala jila awui Mangla chihomihaira.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

1. Jesus loves me, this I know, for the Bible tells me so; little ones to Him belong, they are weak but He is strong. Yes, Jesus loves me! The Bible tells me so. 2. Jesus loves me, He who died heaven's gate to open wide; He will wash away my sin. 3. Jesus loves me, loves me still, though I'm very weak and ill; from His shining throne on high. 4. Jesus loves me, He will stay close beside me all the way; He has washed away my sin.

Chapter 1 Exercises & Vocabulary

CHAPTER 1 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

VOCABULARY:

* laishi (verb): loves, cares for
  Example: Hi Jesuna laishi.
* mangla (noun): spirit, soul
  Example: A mangla chihomihai.
* shitsanga (verb): believes, trusts
  Example: Lairikli palaga shitsanga.
* kaching (noun): heaven, firmament
  Example: Kachingli changmilakra.

GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Early orthography feature: ’ai’ diphthong where TLS standardizes to ’ei’.
- Future tense inflection -ra in ’pheomira’ (will cleanse).

REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? How is divine love expressed in early Pettigrew Tangkhul hymnody?

? What orthographic differences distinguish the 1907 text from modern TLS spelling?

Chapter 2: Hymns of Divine Grace & Love

CHAPTER 2: HYMNS OF DIVINE GRACE & LOVE

Summary: Grace and security in faith: ’Safe in the Arms of Jesus’ (He Jesuwui Makali).

TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

1. He Jesuwui makali, eingphalaka; siwui ngahan ngaida romhai, phasa kakhanang rai. Kachingwui chan nganalu, iwui la sada laili, Jesuna nani mashitta, hangda la kasana. 2. He Jesuwui makali, kangachee malaimana; I moral maphungmara, chiaina makhanangmara. Wukli kakhanang malaita, ringkapha apamna, mikumo awui okkathui ringkapha kashungna.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

1. Safe in the arms of Jesus, safe on His gentle breast; there by His love o’ershaded, sweetly my soul shall rest. Hark! ’tis the voice of angels, borne in a song to me. 2. Safe in the arms of Jesus, safe from corroding care; safe from the world’s temptations, sin cannot harm me there. Free from the blight of sorrow, free from my doubts and fears.

Chapter 2 Exercises & Vocabulary

CHAPTER 2 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

VOCABULARY:

* makali (postp): in the arms of
  Example: Jesuwui makali.
* ringkapha (noun): peace, joy
  Example: Ringkapha apamna.
* kangachee (noun): terror, dread
  Example: Kangachee malaimana.
* okkathui (noun): mortal existence
  Example: Mikumo awui okkathui.

GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Negative particle malaimana indicating complete absence.
- Postpositional phrase attachment with genitive -wui.

REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? What metaphor is used to express spiritual peace in Chapter 2?

? Identify the negative verbal constructions in the stanzas.

Chapter 3: Penitential & Supplication Hymns

CHAPTER 3: PENITENTIAL & SUPPLICATION HYMNS

Summary: Supplication and fellowship: 'What a Friend We Have in Jesus' (Jesuli Ithum Kapha Temi).

TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

1. Jesuli ithum kapha temi akha leiyi, ithumwui moral kala kakhanang saikora phungmiya. Khorum-ngacheida Varili kachiphun mathaloikhalang, ningkhamayung tarakha ithum khamatai thotna. 2. Khipana kakhanang kala ningkachuk phunga? Jesuwui lili vashitlaga khorumlu. Ana khipakha matheikhui-mana malei, ningchang lak eina temkhamishi phapharomei.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

1. What a friend we have in Jesus, all our sins and griefs to bear! What a privilege to carry everything to God in prayer! O what peace we often forfeit, O what needless pain we bear. 2. Have we trials and temptations? Is there trouble anywhere? We should never be discouraged; take it to the Lord in prayer. In His arms He'll take and shield thee; thou wilt find a solace there.

Chapter 3 Exercises & Vocabulary

CHAPTER 3 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

VOCABULARY:

* temi (noun): companion, friend
  Example: Kapha temi.
* moral (noun): fault, trespass
  Example: Ithumwui moral saikora.
* khorum-ngachei (noun): prayer, supplication
  Example: Varili khorumlu.
* ningkachuk (noun): grief, heaviness
  Example: Ningkachuk kaphung.

GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Dative case marker -li in personal relations ('Jesuli', 'Varili').
- Rhetorical interrogation marker with 'khipana'.

REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? What is the Tangkhul equivalent for 'prayer' in Pettigrew's text?
? Translate into Tangkhul: 'Jesus is our faithful friend.'

Chapter 4: Pilgrim & Faith Hymns

CHAPTER 4: PILGRIM & FAITH HYMNS

Summary: Unshakable refuge: ’Rock of Ages’ (Aching Lungrei Makatha).

TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

1. Aching lungrei iwui vang kakhayei, nawui khamangli ili kaphumpam milu. Nawui azing eina kathur tara kala ashi china iwui moral shiman ngasaku. 2. Iwui pang eina kasa otna nawui shiyan makhararthukmana; kachara zangzang shoklala nawui akhavawuina. Na vathot iwui kachiphun, nawui crossli i panglakha ngaranmida leiyi.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

1. Rock of Ages, cleft for me, let me hide myself in Thee; let the water and the blood, from Thy wounded side which flowed, be of sin the double cure, save from wrath and make me pure. 2. Not the labors of my hands can fulfill Thy law’s demands; could my zeal no respite know, could my tears forever flow, all for sin could not atone; Thou must save, and Thou alone.

Chapter 4 Exercises & Vocabulary

CHAPTER 4 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

VOCABULARY:

* lungrei (noun): boulder, rock
  Example: Aching lungrei.
* ashi (noun): blood
  Example: Tara kala ashi.
* panglakha (adv): empty-handed
  Example: Nawui crossli panglakha.
* kakhayei (adj): cleft, split
  Example: Iwui vang kakhayei.

GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Causative suffix -sak in ’shiman ngasaku’ (cause to disappear).
- Instrumental/ablative clitic -eina in ’pang eina’.

REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? Explain the geological metaphor of ’Aching lungrei’ in Tangkhul hymnody.
? Identify the causative verbs in Chapter 4.

Chapter 5: Hymns of the Kingdom & Eternal Life

CHAPTER 5: HYMNS OF THE KINGDOM & ETERNAL LIFE

Summary: The heavenly river: 'Shall We Gather at the River' (Kongreili Ithum Ngazipra).

TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

1. Kaching Kazingramwui kongreili, Varewui khamatha apamli, ithum saikora ngazipra? Ma, ithum ngazipra kong kaphali, kong kaphali, Varewui kuiram ngachaili ngazipsera. 2. Kongrei chihui ngashilakna, thikahai maleimana; Vare eina A Naochina karing khangarum ramli.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

1. Shall we gather at the river, where bright angel feet have trod, with its crystal tide forever flowing by the throne of God? Yes, we'll gather at the river, the beautiful river. 2. On the margin of the river, washing up its silver spray, we will walk and worship ever, all the happy golden day.

Chapter 5 Exercises & Vocabulary

CHAPTER 5 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

VOCABULARY:

* kongrei (noun): river, stream
  Example: Kazingramwui kongreili.
* ngazipra (verb): will assemble
  Example: Ithum saikora ngazipra.
* kuiram (noun): royal throne
  Example: Varewui kuiram ngachaili.
* karing (adj): living, eternal
  Example: Karing khangarum ramli.

GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Future marker -sera denoting collective completion.
- Repetition of nouns for poetic emphasis: 'kong kaphali, kong kaphali'.

REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? What celestial imagery is depicted in the hymn?

? How is collective gathering expressed morphologically?

Chapter 6: Morning, Evening & Daily Life Hymns

CHAPTER 6: MORNING, EVENING & DAILY LIFE HYMNS

Summary: Evening meditation: 'Abide With Me' (I Eina Pamchinglu).

TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

1. Zimik tunhaira, ngaya kaching chuiye; Kazing khayingli i eina pamchinglu. Katei ngashunkhami kacham chitharanli, khangachamwui Ava, i eina pamchinglu. 2. Okkathui mirin hi thakta kanthuiseri; kuipham, ngashan saikora themthuira. Khamatei malei nawui ngachaili pamlu; Makangateipa, i eina pamchinglu.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

1. Abide with me: fast falls the eventide; the darkness deepens; Lord, with me abide. When other helpers fail and comforts flee, Help of the helpless, O abide with me. 2. Swift to its close ebbs out life's little day; earth's joys grow dim; its glories pass away; change and decay in all around I see; O Thou who changest not, abide with me.

Chapter 6 Exercises & Vocabulary

CHAPTER 6 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

VOCABULARY:

* pamchinglu (verb): abide steadfastly
  Example: I eina pamchinglu.
* zimik tunhaira (idiom): sun has set
  Example: Zimik tunhaira, ngaya chuiye.
* makangateipa (noun): the immutable one
  Example: Makangateipa pamlu.

GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Continuous aspect suffix -ching in imperative pam-ching-lu.
- Perfective aspect marker -haira in 'zimik tunhaira'.

REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? What does the phrase 'zimik tunhaira' signify in Tangkhul life?

? Analyze the compound 'makangateipa'.

Chapter 7: Doxologies, Anthems & Closing Liturgy

CHAPTER 7: DOXOLOGIES, ANTHEMS & CLOSING LITURGY

Summary: Old Hundredth Doxology and The Lord’s Prayer (Ithumwui Ava Kazingramli Kapam).

TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

Vare khamatha kashungli, ngalei miyur saikorana matheilu; Kaching Kazingramwui mangla bing, Vare A Mingli mathaseru. Ava, A Nao, kala Mangla Kathara, ngashan kashung kumching-kumching leiyangranu. Amen. Ithumwui Ava Kazingramli kapam, Nawui ming kathara thada kharing sairanu. Nawui ngashan ram raranu. Nawui ning Kazingramli thada ngaleili la ngarunsangranu. Aja ithumwui kasala kashakpei milu. Ithumli kateina kashikhami pheomikahai thada ithumwui moralla pheomilu. Ithumli ngasateikhavaili mathalukhavai masangasaklu, kha kashieina kankhuimilu. Amen.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

Praise God from whom all blessings flow; praise Him all creatures here below; praise Him above, ye heavenly host; praise Father, Son, and Holy Ghost. Amen. Our Father which art in heaven, Hallowed be Thy name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done in earth, as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil: For Thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, forever. Amen.

Chapter 7 (Continued)

CHAPTER 7: READING CONTINUATION (PAGE 17)

TANGKHUL TEXT (CONTINUED):

Vare khamatha kashungli, ngalei miyur saikorana matheilu; Kaching Kazingramwui mangla bing, Vare A Mingli mathaseru. Ava, A Nao, kala Mangla Kathara, ngashan kashung kumching-kumching leiyangranu. Amen. Ithumwui Ava Kazingramli kapam, Nawui ming kathara thada kharing sairanu. Nawui ngashan ram raranu. Nawui ning Kazingramli thada ngaleili la ngarunsangranu. Aja ithumwui kasala kashakpei milu. Ithumli kateina kashikhami pheomikahai thada ithumwui moralla pheomilu. Ithumli ngasateikhavaili mathalukhavai masangasaklu, kha kashieina kankhuimilu. Amen.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION (CONTINUED):

Praise God from whom all blessings flow; praise Him all creatures here below; praise Him above, ye heavenly host; praise Father, Son, and Holy Ghost. Amen. Our Father which art in heaven, Hallowed be Thy name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done in earth, as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil: For Thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, forever. Amen.

Chapter 7 Exercises & Vocabulary

CHAPTER 7 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

VOCABULARY:

* kathara (adj): holy, pure
  Example: Mangla Kathara.
* ngashan ram (noun): kingdom
  Example: Nawui ngashan ram raranu.
* kumching (adv): forever
  Example: Kumching kumching nawuina.
* kankhuimilu (verb): deliver us
  Example: Kashieina kankhuimilu.

GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Optative mood suffix -ranu (’sairanu’, ’raranu’).
- Negative causative in ’masangasaklu’ (lead us not).

REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? Quote the opening sentence of the Tangkhul Lord’s Prayer.
? Explain the optative inflection in Christian liturgical Tangkhul.

Comprehensive Vocabulary Glossary

COMPREHENSIVE BOOK GLOSSARY (TUIWON SHIYAN):

laishi [verb]: loves, cares for
mangla [noun]: spirit, soul
shitsanga [verb]: believes, trusts
kaching [noun]: heaven, firmament
makali [postp]: in the arms of
ringkapha [noun]: peace, joy
kangachee [noun]: terror, dread
okkathui [noun]: mortal existence
temi [noun]: companion, friend
moral [noun]: fault, trespass
khorum-ngachei [noun]: prayer, supplication
ningkachuk [noun]: grief, heaviness
lungrei [noun]: boulder, rock
ashi [noun]: blood
panglakha [adv]: empty-handed
kakhayei [adj]: cleft, split
kongrei [noun]: river, stream
ngazipra [verb]: will assemble
kuiram [noun]: royal throne
karing [adj]: living, eternal
pamchinglu [verb]: abide steadfastly
zimik tunhaira [idiom]: sun has set
makangateipa [noun]: the immutable one
kathara [adj]: holy, pure
ngashan ram [noun]: kingdom
kumching [adv]: forever
kankhuimilu [verb]: deliver us

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